

Product Operating System

Operating Model & Playbook (v1.0)

Connecting Product, Strategy, Execution, and Continuous Improvement

Author: Craig Edgmon

Date: 6/23/2026

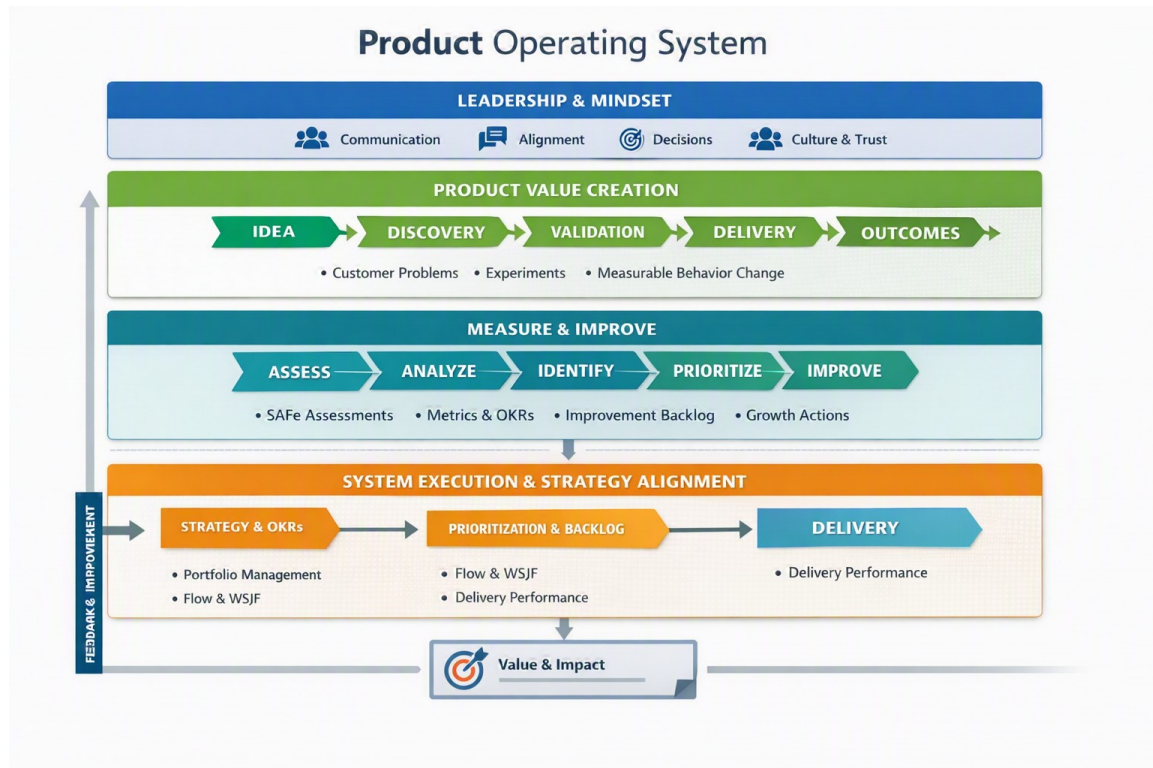
1. Executive Summary

Organizations often struggle to connect strategy, product execution, and continuous improvement into a coherent system. This playbook introduces a Product Operating System (POS) designed to unify these functions into a single model. The objective is to align strategy with execution, enable teams to deliver measurable outcomes, and establish a structured approach to continuous improvement.

2. The Problem

Many organizations operate with fragmented systems. Product teams focus on delivery, strategy is defined at a high level without clear execution linkage, and improvement activities are reactive. This results in misalignment, inefficiencies, and a focus on output rather than outcomes.

3. The Product Operating System Model



The model is structured across four layers: product value creation, strategy alignment, continuous improvement, and leadership enablement.

4. Core Principles

- One system of execution with a single prioritized backlog
- Focus on outcomes rather than output
- Continuous improvement through structured feedback loops
- Alignment between strategy and execution

5. Product Value Creation

This layer ensures teams focus on validated customer problems and measurable value delivery. It spans idea generation, discovery, validation, delivery, and outcome measurement.

6. Strategy Alignment

Strategy is translated into execution through clear objectives and prioritization mechanisms. Objectives and Key Results (OKRs) connect strategic intent to delivery and guide decision-making.

7. Continuous Improvement

The improvement loop provides a structured way to assess performance, identify gaps, and implement targeted improvements. Inputs include delivery metrics, strategic outcomes, and assessment frameworks.

8. System Execution

Execution focuses on delivering value efficiently through flow-based delivery and backlog prioritization. Work is continuously refined, prioritized, and delivered based on impact and strategic alignment.

9. Leadership & Mindset

Leadership provides the enabling environment for the system. This includes setting direction, ensuring alignment, and fostering a culture that supports continuous learning and effective decision-making.

10. Operating Model and Cadence

Daily: Product discovery and delivery activities.

Sprint: Execution cycles and retrospectives.

Quarterly: Strategy review, OKR alignment, and improvement planning.

11. Metrics Framework

Product: Customer outcomes and engagement.

Delivery: Lead time, throughput, quality.

System: OKR achievement and improvement effectiveness.

12. Conclusion

The Product Operating System provides a practical and scalable framework to unify strategy, product execution, and continuous improvement. It enables organizations to operate with clarity, alignment, and adaptability.